

JOSE A. ESPINOZA

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Strategic Offensive Security Leader

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Offensive security leader with 10+ years across penetration testing, red teaming, and security program development. Manage high-performing penetration testing teams while staying hands-on as technical SME for complex web application, cloud infrastructure, and AI penetration tests. Built and scaled an Agentic AI vulnerability discovery practice that has uncovered logic flaws and zero-day vulnerabilities beyond the reach of manual review and automated scanning. 2x President's Club Award winner, scaling department revenue past \$9.2M annually with exceptionally low team turnover.

CORE COMPETENCIES & SKILLS

Leadership & Operations: Executive Advisory (CISO-level), Strategic Budgeting and Roadmapping, Talent Development and Retention, Threat-Informed Defense Strategy, SOC and Incident Response Integration, Cross-Functional Alignment

Agentic AI & Automation: Agentic AI Vulnerability Discovery, LLM Security and Exploitation, Claude Code, Gemini-CLI, Shannon AI, AI Risk Management, Automation Scaling

Offensive Security: Web Application Penetration Testing, Cloud Infrastructure Penetration Testing (AWS, GCP, Azure), FedRAMP 3PAO Assessments, Internal and External Penetration Testing, PCI-DSS Assessments, Microsoft Azure and Office 365 Security

Tools & Languages: Bash, Python, Burp Suite Pro, Tenable Nessus, Rapid7 InsightVM, AppSpider Enterprise; Bilingual English and Spanish

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager, Threat Team — Tavora Business Solutions, Inc., Fairfax, VA

July 2022 – Present

- Lead an offensive security team of 5 direct reports plus a rotating pipeline of 2-3 interns per cycle, owning pre-sales scoping, engagement delivery, and career development.
- Advise client CISOs and senior security leadership directly, translating complex threat findings into prioritized, business-aligned remediation roadmaps.
- 2x President's Club Award winner for consistently exceeding department revenue goals, currently scaling past \$9.2M annually.
- Pioneered an Agentic AI penetration testing practice using Claude Code, Gemini-CLI, and Shannon AI, identifying complex logic flaws and zero-day vulnerabilities that bypassed manual review and traditional scanners.
- Served as technical lead for the firm's successful FedRAMP Third Party Assessment Organization (3PAO) certification; direct cloud penetration tests for Cloud Service Providers pursuing FedRAMP Authorization.
- Maintain near-zero team turnover through individualized development plans; mentored engineers to advanced certifications including OSWE.
- Partner with sales and executive teams on SOWs, RFPs, and Salesforce pipeline optimization to maximize team utilization.
- Serve as technical SME and escalation point for complex web application, cloud infrastructure, and AI penetration tests.

Information Security Consultant — Tavora Business Solutions, Inc., Fairfax, VA

March 2020 – July 2022

- Led penetration tests and vulnerability assessments across network, web application, and cloud environments for clients in regulated industries.
- Performed internal and external penetration testing and PCI-DSS scoped assessments.
- Authored executive and technical reports communicating risk clearly and driving successful remediation of critical vulnerabilities.

Cyber Security Engineer — State Corporation Commission, Richmond, VA

January 2016 – March 2020

- Rebuilt the Vulnerability Management program around validated, known-exploitable findings, using Rapid7 InsightVM and AppSpider Enterprise with executive-level reporting and metrics.
- Security lead for the Office 365/ADFS cloud migration covering Exchange Online, Office Online, and SharePoint Online.
- Created Windows and Windows Server hardening standards based on Department of Defense STIGs.
- Performed incident response duties including mitigation and reporting; trained in Red Team Penetration Testing and Cloud Exploitation at Black Hat 2017 and 2019.

Systems Analyst II, Risk and Security — Virginia Premier Health Plan, Inc., Richmond, VA

June 2013 – January 2016

- Implemented security controls and Standard Operating Procedures to mature an early-stage security and risk program.
- Established a monthly server patch management process to remediate critical vulnerabilities.
- Launched a Security Awareness program with annual training, monthly newsletters, and quarterly contests.
- Deployed a SIEM to centralize event logging and reduce incident response time.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Systems — Virginia Commonwealth University, Richmond, VA (2013)

CERTIFICATIONS

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- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), ISC2 — 2023-2028, Member ID 1057860
 - GIAC Penetration Tester (GPEN) — 2019-2027, Analyst Number 13612
 - Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) — 2019, Credential ID OS-101-49446